

Background

- When reporting the results of a test, labs generally report the results in units based on their institutional or local guidelines
- In clinical trials where multiple sites and regions are involved, we end up having the same test results in different units for different subjects/timepoints
- It becomes a challenge when we try to summarize (for example, calculate average result in a group of subjects) when these units are different
- So, we try to convert the results to a 'standard unit'
- For this conversion, we need to know the original unit, standard unit, and the conversion factor
- For established organizations, these conversion factors are created, updated, and maintained in a central location for all tests that organization may need.
- If no such standard exists, study team (programmers, statisticians in consultation with clinicians) agrees upon the standard units and establishes conversion factors at the trial level
- Programmers will then use the conversion factors to create result variables in standard units (eg: LBSTRESN, LBSTRESC)